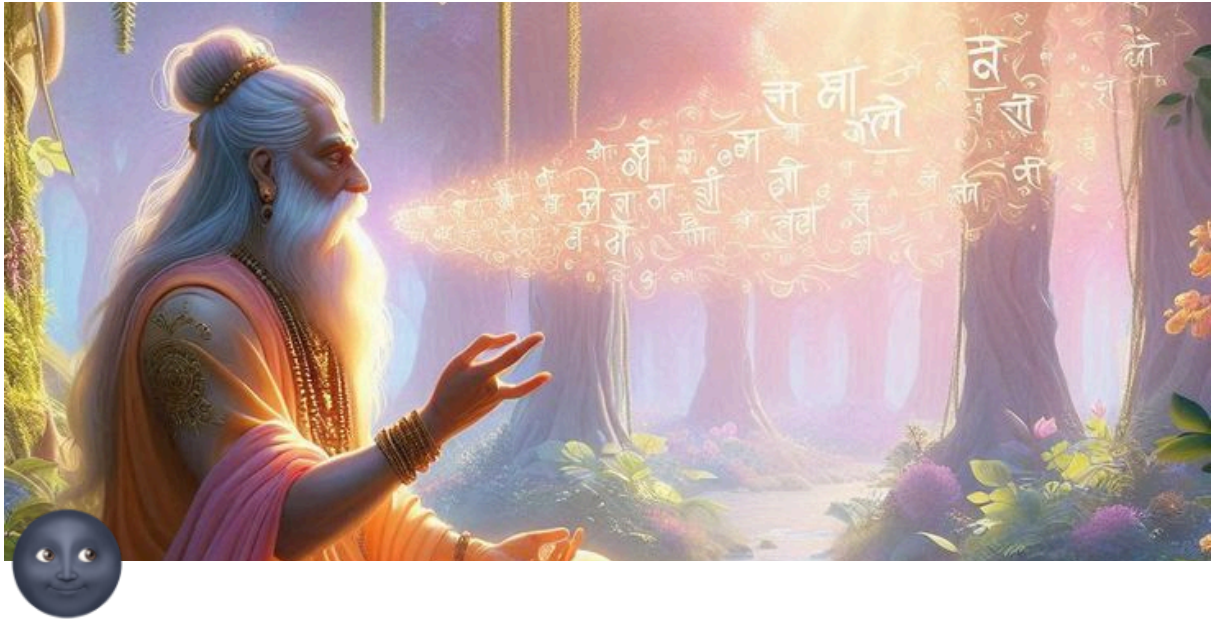




Yoga

*"yogena chittasya padena vacham
malam sharirasya cha vaidyakena
yo'pakarottamam pravaram muninam
patanjalin pranjaliranato'smi"*

Sutra II.18

II.18 *prakasa kriya sthiti sila, bhutendriyatmakam bhogapavargartham drisyam*

"The material world manifests itself in immobility, activity or clarity. It is made up of natural elements and sensory organs. The reason for this manifestation is to enjoy it or to free oneself from it."

This sutra shows that Prakriti is the platform for **experiencing life**. Either in enjoying its pleasures or acquiring liberation.

Both are necessary steps in our path. However, attachment (to pleasures) and liberation are intimately linked. A yogi needs to experience both to get **the full experience** that Prakriti offers.

Yoga=योग

Yoga refers to **union, feeling of integration**. It refers to union of body and mind, Prakriti with Purusa. This union has been practiced for **thousands of years**. Yoga practice simply leads to the relaxation of this union.

A definition of yoga according to the **Bhagavad Gita - The maturity of God-** is summarized in Chapter 6, Verse 23.

*"tam vidyad duhkha-samyoga-viyogam yoga-samjñitam sa
niscayena yuktavyo yogo 'nirvinna-cetasa"*

*"The state of breaking union with misery is known as Yoga.
This Yoga must be resolutely practiced with determination free
from pessimism."*

tam : that

vidyāt : you should know

duḥkha saṁyoga viyogam : the state of breaking union with misery

yoga samjñitam : is called yoga

saḥ : that

nīśayena : regularly

yuktavyaḥ : must be practiced

yogaḥ : yoga

anirvinṇa cetasā : with determination

In the Bhagavad Gita, the material world is **the realm of Maya**, described by **Sri Krishna** as temporary, full of suffering and misery. So Maya (Prakriti) is experienced to break away from it and finally and principally energy is returned to primordial divine energy (Purusa), the impact of this pure divine energy is eternal and unlimited. Yoga is the vehicle opening up and experiencing Purusa energy.



Definition of Yoga according to Patanjari's Yoga Sutra.

1.2 Yoga citta vritti nirodha

"Yoga is the cessation of the automatic activity of the mind."

yoga : Yoga

chitta: peripheral awareness, mental

vritti: agitation, modification, disturbance

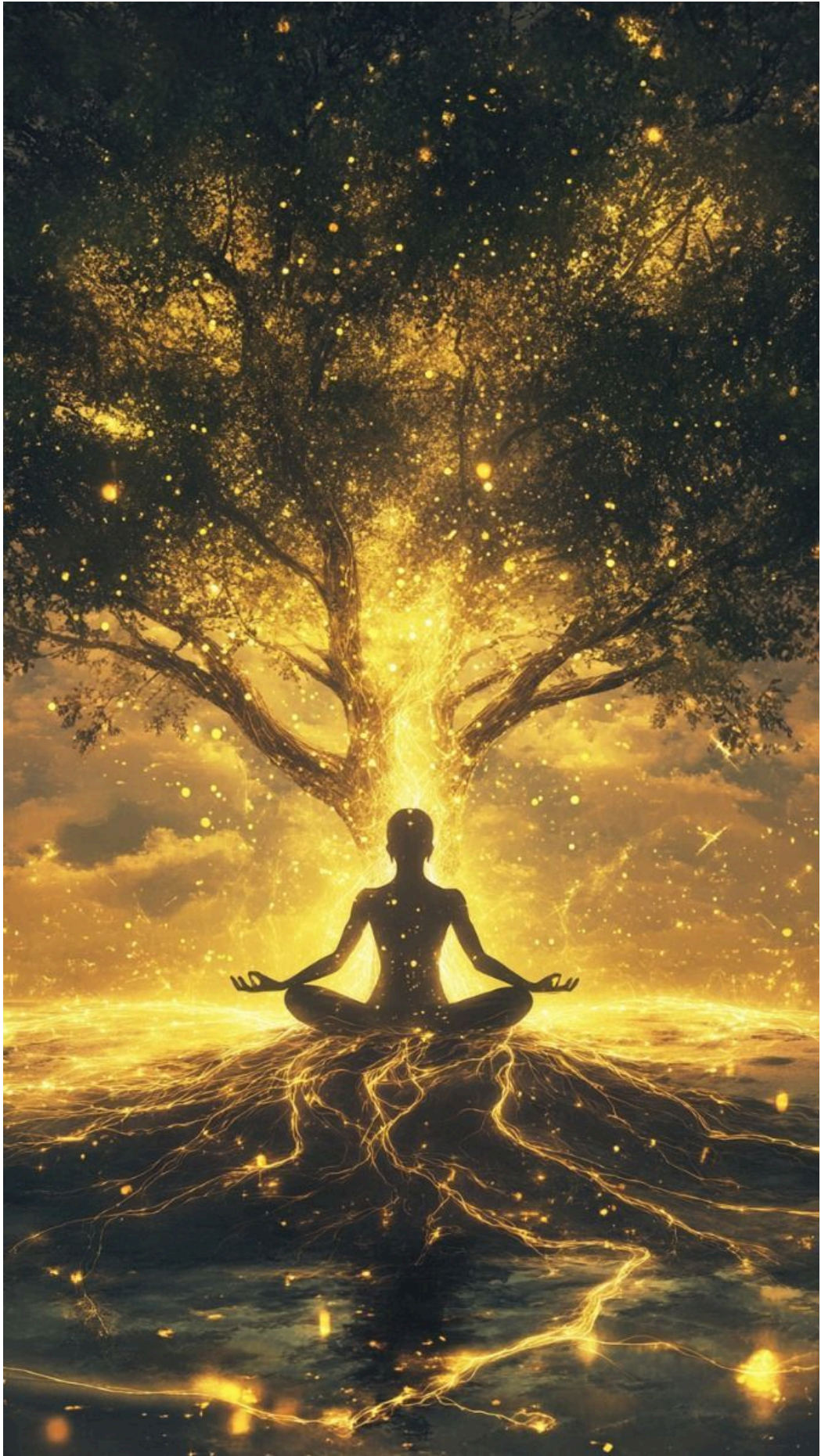
nirodha: cessation, interruption

Citta :

Citta is often translated as "mind" or "spirit", but it's a much more complex concept. Citta includes **Manas** - the mind, **Buddhi** - the intellect and **Ahamkara** - the ego.

- **Manas** is the part of consciousness that thinks according to the signals sent by the receiving organs (eyes, ears, etc.). This is why Manas is known as the "king of the senses". By its very nature, Manas leads indecision and doubt.
- **Buddhi** will enable you to make decisions. It's the part of Citta that enables us to distinguish between the pros and cons, and thus make these choices.
- **Ahamkara** corresponds to our ego in our consciousness. It is this entity gives us our identity. We find it in Descartes' famous "I think, therefore I am".

We tend to confuse Cit and Citta, in several respects. Firstly, between the phonetics of the two words, but above all on their nature. Cit is an attribute of Purusa, while Citta is an attribute of Prakriti. A common mistake is to identify our consciousness with Purusa. This is why Citta is considered to be a consciousness that has borrowed our property of observer (Cit) from our divine Consciousness (Purusa).

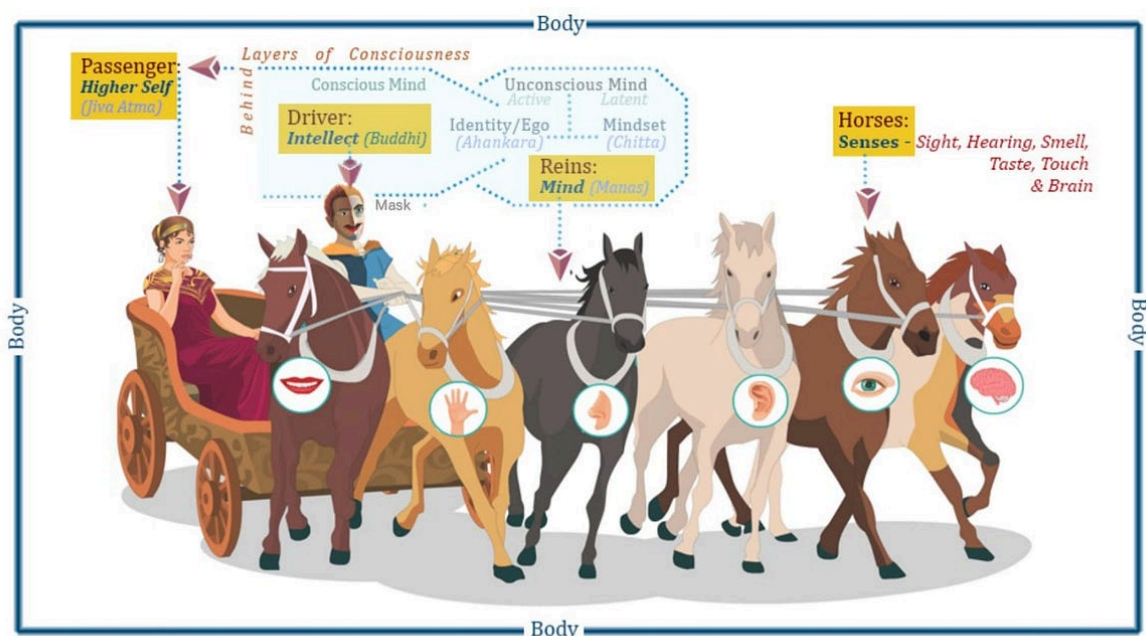


"Merge your consciousness into your Soul, to experience the True Darshan,
Hari Om Tat sat"

The chariot metaphor:

In several Upanishads, including the Katha Upanishad, where the word yoga first appears (around 600 B.C), the human being is compared to a chariot drawn by 5 horses.

- The structure of the chariot is compared to our physical body.
- The 5 horses are the organs of the 5 senses: sight, hearing, taste, smell and touch.
- The roads in front of the chariot are the various objects of the senses.
- The reins represent the mental functions (Manas) that direct the horses.
- The charioteer (Buddhi) is our intuitive intelligence/intellect, thought.
- The chariot contains a passenger: it's our spirit, **the Atman** who is the self. Every human being is the master of his carriage.



Analogy - Body is a Chariot (Katha Upanishad)

With permission- Gnana Yoga

Vritti nirodha:

Vritti corresponds to the **fluctuations of citta** and **nirodha means to stop**.

As we have seen, Citta is a projection of our True Self. It is by stopping the fluctuations (the vrittis) of Citta that we can rediscover our True Self.

Let's think of the moon as the Purusa, the moon's projection onto a lake as the citta. Our observation of the moon in the lake will be disturbed by any **ripples** (pebbles, waves, etc.) that correspond to vrittis.

So the practice of yoga consists in stopping the fluctuations of thought in order to **contemplate and fully experience Purusa**.



"Quiet your thoughts, Quiet your Mind, Quiet your Intellect, Quiet your ego, only then you will experience Yoga and meet Your True Self "